

Finding support: On Operation Sindoor, international reaction

India must pressure Pakistan by sharing evidence of the terror trail

The international reaction to India's **strikes** on terrorist **infrastructure** in Pakistan **has** been one of concern, but **muted** and **non-recriminatory**, indicating that for most world capitals, India's **actions** in response to the Pahalgam attacks **were** more or less expected, and even understood. While there have been **calls for restraint** and **resolution** through **dialogue** and **diplomacy**, there has been little action taken by any country to **bring about** much pressure to **avert** the strikes. This can be **chalked up** to New Delhi's **briefings** to **envoys**, and calls by the Prime Minister, Ministers and the National Security Adviser to **counterparts** around the world through this crisis, that began with the Pahalgam terror attack on April 22. New Delhi's mature messaging has been that India is targeting terrorists that it hoped Pakistan would, especially after the "**barbaric**" nature of the Pahalgam attack. The Indian Air Force's **operations** on May 7, on targets identified with terror groups, **were** **precisely** planned, with India's **assurance** that no civil, economic or military locations **would** be hit. It was also impossible to escape the **symbolism** — **details** of the operations **were** delivered by two women officers of different faiths, sending out an image of progressive, **pluralistic** and **resolute** nation.

With further operations overnight, it is clear that tensions continue to rise. The U.K., the U.S., Russia, and the UN have **reached out** to New Delhi and Islamabad to try and **defuse** tensions, and the arrival of the Saudi and Iranian Foreign Ministers in India indicates some of those **apprehensions**. The government must be careful that its well-prepared response **thus far** is not **derailed** by an unplanned escalation, especially one **provoked** by Pakistan. While Pakistan has fewer friends, it is not without **allies** such as China, Türkiye and Malaysia, all of whom have **backed** its call for an "independent investigation", and the government would do well to keep its global message **reasoned** and **rational**. It could also offer to share evidence on the terror trail at the UN and other agencies **in order to** bring more pressure on Pakistan to act against the groups responsible. In doing so, New Delhi must avoid the **pitfalls** of being "**hyphenated**" with Pakistan, allowing **bilateral** matters to become internationalised, or needing **mediation**. **To that end**, the government may consider, if it has not already, opening a channel of communication, as the NSA had with Pakistani **interlocutors**, to **de-escalate** tensions after the **misfiring** of an Indian missile into Pakistan and to **forge** the LoC ceasefire agreement in 2021. While New Delhi's **messaging**, of fighting the **scourge** of terrorism, **will** always find it **unequivocal** support in every part of the world, an all-out **war** with Pakistan in an **unstable neighbourhood** **is** counter-productive and in no one's interest.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

1. **Trail** (noun) – track, trace, path, route, footprint निशान
2. **Strike** (noun) – attack, assault, raid, offensive, operation हमला
3. **Infrastructure** (noun) – framework, foundation, facilities, base, system आधारभूत ढाँचा
4. **Muted** (adjective) – subdued, soft, restrained, quiet, low-key मंद
5. **Non-recriminatory** (adjective) – non-accusatory, non-blaming, non-condemning, impartial, neutral दोषारोपण से रहित
6. **Call for** (phrasal verb) – request, demand, urge, appeal for, ask for माँग करना
7. **Restraint** (noun) – control, moderation, self-restraint, discipline, composure संयम
8. **Resolution** (noun) – settlement, solution, decision, agreement, conclusion समाधान
9. **Dialogue** (noun) – conversation, discussion, talks, negotiation, communication संवाद
10. **Diplomacy** (noun) – negotiation, tact, foreign affairs, statesmanship, mediation कूटनीति
11. **Bring about** (phrasal verb) – cause, result in, lead to, generate, create लाना (परिणामस्वरूप)
12. **Avert** (verb) – prevent, avoid, deter, ward off, preclude टालना
13. **Chalk up** (phrasal verb) – attribute, credit, record, register, count as कारण मानना
14. **Briefing** (noun) – update, report, information, communication, instruction जानकारी देना
15. **Envoy** (noun) – diplomat, ambassador, representative, emissary, delegate दूत
16. **Counterpart** (noun) – equivalent, peer, match, equal, colleague समकक्ष
17. **Barbaric** (adjective) – brutal, savage, inhuman, cruel, uncivilized बर्बर
18. **Precisely** (adverb) – exactly, accurately, correctly, clearly, strictly ठीक-ठीक
19. **Assurance** (noun) – guarantee, promise, certainty, pledge, commitment आश्वासन
20. **Symbolism** (noun) – representation, imagery, metaphor, signification, emblem प्रतीकात्मकता
21. **Pluralistic** (adjective) – diverse, inclusive, multicultural, tolerant, varied बहुलवादी

22. **Resolute** (adjective) – determined, firm, unwavering, steadfast, strong दृढ़
23. **Reach out** (phrasal verb) – contact, connect, communicate, approach, extend संपर्क करना
24. **Defuse** (verb) – calm, ease, reduce, pacify, neutralize तनाव कम करना
25. **Apprehension** (noun) – anxiety, fear, concern, worry, unease आशंका
26. **Thus far** (phrasal verb) – until now, up to this point, so far, hitherto, to date अब तक
27. **Derail** (verb) – disrupt, hinder, throw off, obstruct, upset बाधा डालना
28. **Provoke** (verb) – incite, instigate, trigger, aggravate, stimulate उकसाना
29. **Ally** (noun) – partner, supporter, friend, confederate, associate सहयोगी
30. **Back** (verb) – support, endorse, uphold, promote, advocate समर्थन करना
31. **Reasoned** (adjective) – logical, well-argued, thoughtful, analytical, rational तर्कसंगत
32. **Rational** (adjective) – logical, sensible, reasonable, sound, coherent विवेकपूर्ण
33. **In order to** (phrase) – so that, for the purpose of, with the intention to, to के उद्देश्य से
34. **Pitfall** (noun) – danger, trap, risk, hazard, snag जोखिम
35. **Hyphenated** (adjective) – linked, combined, connected, compound, associated जोड़ा हुआ (विशेषकर जटिल संबंधों में)
36. **Bilateral** (adjective) – mutual, two-sided, reciprocal, joint, dual द्विपक्षीय
37. **Mediation** (noun) – negotiation, arbitration, intervention, conciliation, intercession मध्यस्थता
38. **To that end** (phrase) – for that purpose, with that aim, accordingly, hence, therefore उस उद्देश्य से
39. **Interlocutor** (noun) – negotiator, speaker, go-between, representative, agent वार्ताकार
40. **De-escalate** (verb) – reduce, lessen, ease, diminish, calm down तनाव कम करना
41. **Misfiring** (noun) – malfunction, failure, error, breakdown, fault चूक (गलत फायरिंग)
42. **Forge** (verb) – create, establish, build, form, develop बनाना
43. **Scourge** (noun) – curse, menace, affliction, plague, evil अभिशाप
44. **Unequivocal** (adjective) – clear, unambiguous, definite, certain, firm स्पष्ट

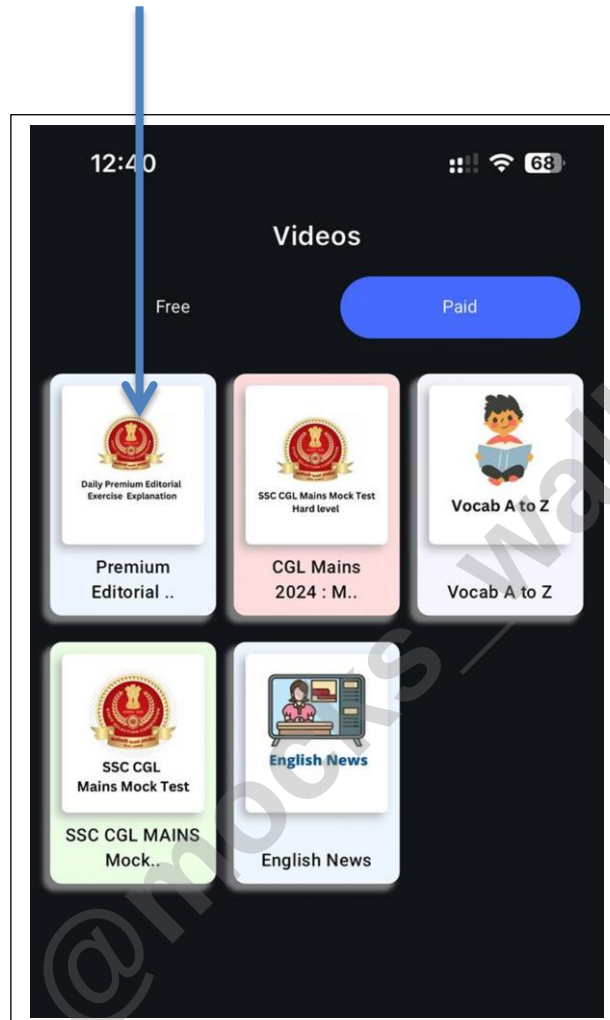
45. **Unstable** (adjective) – volatile, insecure, shaky, unpredictable, fragile अस्थिर

46. **Neighbourhood** (noun) – vicinity, area, region, surroundings, locale पड़ोस (क्षेत्र)

47. **Counter-productive** (adjective) – self-defeating, harmful, ineffective, adverse, backfiring प्रतिकूल प्रभाव डालने वाला

@mocks_wallah

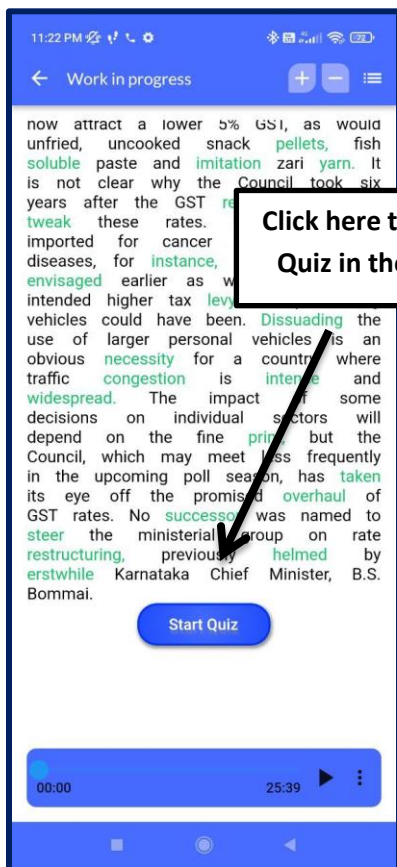
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Summary of the Editorial

1. Muted Global Response – Most countries reacted with concern but refrained from criticizing India's strikes following the Pahalgam terror attack.
2. India's Expected Action – India's military response was anticipated and somewhat accepted globally, given the nature of the terror strike.
3. Diplomatic Outreach – India conducted extensive briefings and direct outreach through its Prime Minister, Ministers, and NSA to garner international understanding.
4. Targeted Operations – The Indian Air Force's May 7 operations were specifically aimed at terror infrastructure, avoiding civilian and military sites.
5. Symbolic Messaging – Two women officers from different faiths presented the operation's details, highlighting India's pluralism and resolve.
6. Ongoing Tensions – Continued strikes indicate a rise in tensions between India and Pakistan.
7. International Mediation Efforts – Countries like the U.S., U.K., Russia, and the UN are attempting to de-escalate the situation.
8. Regional Engagement – Visits by Saudi and Iranian foreign ministers reflect regional concerns about the standoff.
9. Avoiding Escalation – India must ensure that its responses remain calculated and are not escalated by Pakistan's provocations.
10. Pakistan's Limited but Present Allies – Nations like China, Türkiye, and Malaysia support Pakistan's demand for an independent probe.
11. Strategic Communication – India should maintain a rational and firm global narrative, emphasizing counter-terrorism.
12. Sharing Evidence – Offering terror-related evidence at the UN could help increase pressure on Pakistan to act.
13. Avoiding Internationalization – India must prevent bilateral issues from becoming international matters requiring mediation.
14. Potential Backchannel Talks – Reviving communication channels with Pakistan, like the 2021 ceasefire dialogue, could help reduce hostilities.
15. War Not a Solution – Despite global sympathy against terrorism, an all-out war with Pakistan would destabilize the region and serve no one's interest.

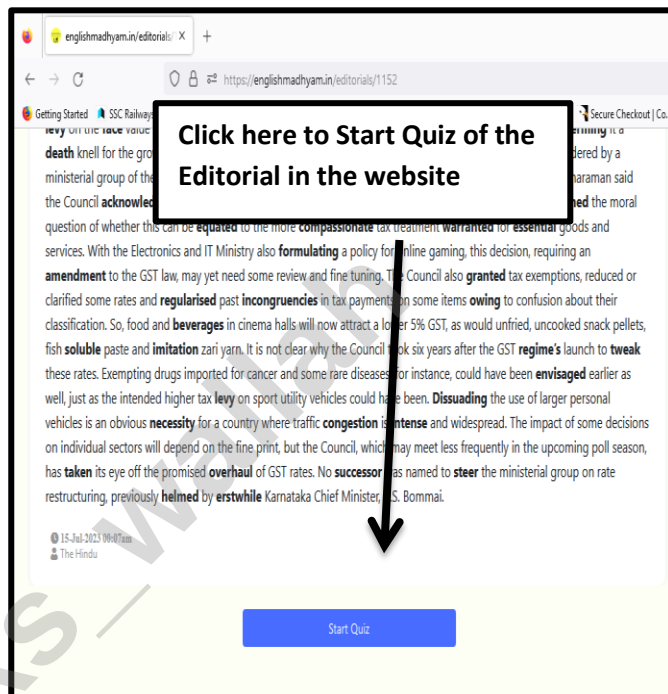
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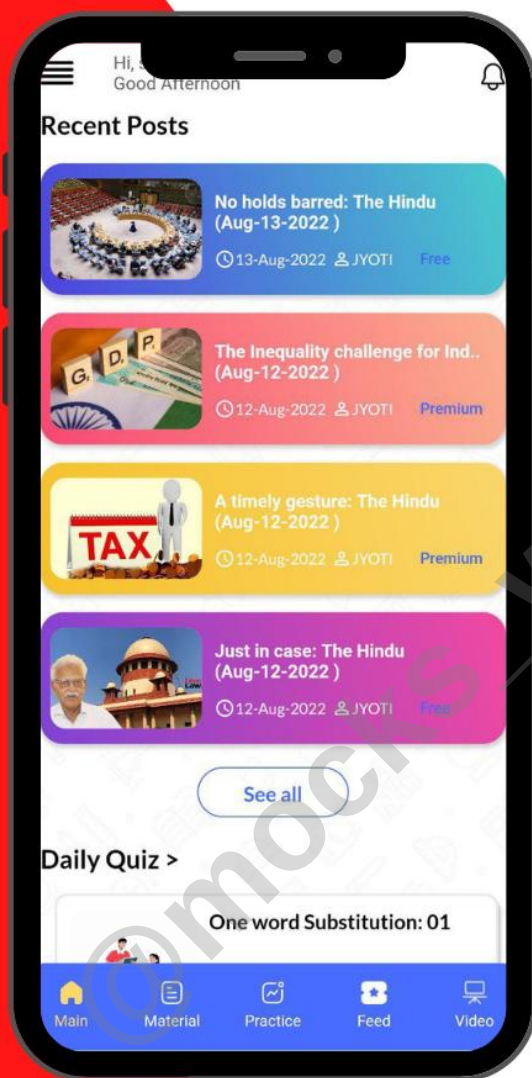
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